

UCO Bank: An INDIAN Institution with Global vision

It's the story of a bank that merges traditional Indian values with a progressive, modern outlook. It owes its birth to the historic 'Quit India' movement that inspired the late G. D. Birla, the founder and the first Chairman of The United Commercial Bank Ltd. (now UCO Bank). It started its formal operations in Calcutta on 10th May, 1943. Sixty-five years down the line, it stands tall as a modern multi-facility bank reaching out to the citizens across India. Shri S.K. Goel, CMD, UCO Bank tells us how, in an interview.

What do you think are UCO bank's USPs?

A truly pan India presence - from the remotest corner of the country to 97 out of India's 100 major business centres. We provide finance to every conceivable section of the Indian economy - micro, small, medium & large enterprises spanning all sectors including retail, agriculture, services and infrastructure. Our achievements in lending to micro, small and medium enterprises won us the "National Award for Excellence in Lending to Micro Enterprises" for the year 2007-08 from the Govt. of India.



Hon'ble Prime Minister handing over the award to CMD, UCO Bank on 30-08-2008 at Vigyan Bhavan, N. Delhi

To take care of the entire financial needs of our customers we market the whole gamut of non-banking financial investment products (including insurance products) at all our branches. Simultaneously, the Bank meets its social commitments through its network in rural and semi urban areas (comprising nearly 2/3rd of its total nationwide branches) by -

- ❖ financing the Priority sectors, Small Scale and Cottage industries;
- ❖ introducing Kissan Samridhi Yojana to cater to the needs of farmers;
- ❖ sponsoring Self Help Groups & Regional Rural Banks in different states, thereby further strengthening our roots in financing rural development projects;
- ❖ fulfilling SLBC lead responsibilities in Orissa & Himachal Pradesh;
- ❖ strengthening our rural services by posting two officers in each rural branch.

What are your focus areas for the current financial year?

Current year, our focus is on following three areas:

A. Enhancing Client Satisfaction through:

- ❑ Organisational restructuring & setting up of Field GMs' offices in different zones of the country to ensure quick and quality services to our clients.
- ❑ Strengthening Alternate Delivery channels by increasing the number of ATMs, both off-site and on-site.
- ❑ Starting Centralised Processing Cells for fast processing of retail loan applications. Web-based Education Loan application facility has already been put in place.

B. Effective Asset Management. Our strategies are aimed at :

- ❑ Utilising our asset processing cells to acquire only good quality assets.
- ❑ Better monitoring to prevent asset slippages.
- ❑ Opening of Asset Recovery branches and expediting recovery through enforcement and compromise.

C. Enriching Values for our Investors - By achieving higher level of profit.

What are the special features of recently launched "UCO Magic Cheques"?

Meant for savings and current account holders of our CBS

Traveller's Cheque
Demand Draft
Gift Cheque
Normal Cheque
Shopping

*It's magic...
make a wish!*

presenting
'UCO Magic Cheque'
- A pre-funded instrument

Features

- For customers having individual Savings/Current Accounts
- Combines features of Demand Draft, Traveller's Cheque, Gift Cheque and normal Cheque
- Available in Rs. 1000/-, Rs. 5000/- and Rs. 10,000/- denominations
- Available in select CBS branches and payable at par at all CBS branches
- Earn interest on balance in Savings Bank Accounts